

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 2

New Patient: Meera – Homework Review & Formulation

Full Detailed – Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Meera (28 y/o Female)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	2 of 16–18	Focus:	Homework review + 5-area formulation

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client brought the diary but only completed entries on 3 out of 7 days due to low energy and motivation (realistic for depression). Clear patterns visible: lowest mood in evenings and after interactions with colleagues/parents. Dominant thoughts center around being judged as not good enough. Today's plan: Review homework honestly, develop 5-area formulation, identify key negative automatic thoughts, and assign new homework.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Meera. How has your week been? I see you brought the diary. How did filling it go?

Client: It was difficult. I only did it on 3 days. I kept forgetting or just didn't have the energy to write. I feel bad about it.

Therapist: That's completely understandable. When someone is feeling low in energy and motivation, even small tasks can feel overwhelming. Three entries are still helpful. Let's look at what you did write.

Client: On Thursday evening after a parent meeting, my mood was 2 out of 10. I kept thinking "They must think I'm a bad teacher." I just went home and lay on the bed for hours.

5-AREA FORMULATION

Therapist: Last session we talked about how thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are connected. Today let's expand that into the full 5-area model. This helps us see the bigger picture more clearly.

Therapist draws the 5 areas and fills it together with the client using Thursday's situation:

Situation: Parent-teacher meeting in the evening

Thoughts: "They must think I'm a bad teacher. Everyone will realize I'm struggling."

Emotions: Anxiety (7/10), Shame (8/10), Hopelessness (6/10)

Physical sensations: Heavy feeling in chest, fatigue, low energy

Behaviors: Withdrew, went home and lay on bed for hours, avoided eating dinner

Therapist: When we look at all five areas together, we can see how the thoughts led to strong shame and low energy, which then led to withdrawing and isolating. Does this make sense to you?

Client: Yeah... I can see how my thoughts made me feel worse and then I just shut down.

IDENTIFYING KEY NEGATIVE AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS

Therapist: From the diary and what you've shared, a few thoughts seem to come up strongly. Let's note them down:

1. "They must think I'm a bad teacher."
2. "Everyone will realize I'm struggling."
3. "I'm not good enough as a teacher."

Therapist: Which of these feels strongest or most painful right now?

Client: The third one — "I'm not good enough as a teacher." That one feels very true.

BEGINNING COGNITIVE WORK

Therapist: Let's gently look at this thought: "I'm not good enough as a teacher." On a scale of 0–100, how much do you believe this right now?

Client: About 80%.

Therapist: Okay. What evidence do you have that supports this thought?

Client: I feel tired all the time. I sometimes make mistakes in class. Some parents have complained. I don't feel as energetic or creative as I used to be.

Therapist: Good. Now, what evidence might go against it — even small things?

Client: (thinking) Some students still like my classes. I've helped a few students improve their marks. My principal has given me positive feedback in the past.

Therapist: That's helpful. If we were to create a more balanced thought, what could it be?

Client: Maybe: "I'm struggling right now, but that doesn't mean I'm completely bad at my job. I still have some strengths."

Therapist: That's a good start. How much do you believe this new thought right now?

Client: About 40%. It feels a bit better, but I still don't fully believe it.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week, I'd like you to continue the diary, and add one small task:

1. Continue the daily mood + thought diary (try to do it at least 4–5 days)
2. For the thought "I'm not good enough as a teacher," write down at least 2 pieces of evidence for and 2 pieces against it
3. Try one small activity that used to give you some pleasure or sense of achievement (even for 10–15 minutes)

Client: I'll try... but I don't know if I'll have the energy.

Therapist: That's okay. Just do what you can. We'll work with whatever you bring next time.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your diary honestly, developed a fuller 5-area formulation, identified your key thoughts, and started gently challenging one of them. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: It was okay. The formulation helped me see things more clearly. I still feel very tired though.

Therapist: That's completely understandable. We'll keep going step by step. Any questions?

Client: Not really.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client completed homework partially (3/7 days) due to low energy — realistic for depression.
- 5-area formulation developed collaboratively and well understood.
- Key negative automatic thought identified. Initial cognitive restructuring started with moderate belief shift (80% → 40%).
- Homework assigned with realistic client hesitation about energy levels.
- Next session: Review new homework, continue cognitive restructuring, introduce behavioral activation more formally.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.